



Goodbye darkness

Lighthouse MV, high-tech sensors monitor power lines to detect outages before they even happen <http://dgit.in/OutageSens>



The next Blackbird

NASA has recently funded Lockheed Martin for an unmanned hypersonic spy plane capable of Mach 6.0 <http://dgit.in/LMSR-72>

Sony MDR-XB950BT headphone

Drop the bass

If it's bass that you are looking for, then you should check out the Sony MDR MDR-XB950BT wireless headphone. It has an over-the-ear design and comes packed with Bluetooth 2.0, NFC and large 40mm drivers. The ear cups have a soft cushioning with a faux-leather finish which is quite comfortable on the ears. The overall finish and design is quite premium and it feels sturdy as well.

The left earpiece houses the power button with an indicator LED, a bass boost button, the microUSB port for charging, a standard 3.5 mm audio jack, and the microphone. The right earpiece has the NFC chip, volume rocker buttons and a sliding button

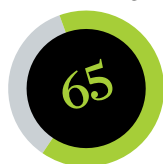


for attending calls and skipping tracks.

Frankly, the sound quality is not very impressive as the drivers have been tuned to give a high bass output. Even when you connect the headphones via an auxiliary cable, the output is still quite high on bass and you need to tinker with your equalizer settings to bring it down. Do think twice when you hit the 'bass boost' button as it completely overpowers the mids and the treble. You can attend calls from the headphones when connected to your smartphone and overall sound quality is quite good.

In terms of battery life, you can get about 15 hours of usage after charging for about 2-3 hours which is quite decent considering the large size of the drivers. The headphones are perfect for someone who like to go high on bass, but for those who prefer a more crisp and flatter sound profile should probably skip this. But with such a high price tag, you don't get the money's worth.

Kunal Khullar



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Specifications

Bluetooth: 3.0; **Drivers:** 40mm (3-28 kHz, with cord); **Weight:** 280gms; **NFC:** Electronic Bass Boost circuitry; **Battery life (Approx):** 20 hours; **Passive operation with auxiliary cable;** A2DP support.

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TP-Link Archer C20i AC750 Wireless Router

Another entrant in the affordable wireless 802.11ac market

Affordable 802.11ac routers are becoming more and more commonplace these days. The Archer C20i is the scaled down version of the C2 with the key differences being that the C2 has Gigabit Ethernet ports and adjustable external antennae. The Archer C20i has three internal antennae near the top of the device while the entire circuitry is towards the bottom. This coupled with the fact that the ports are also situated near the bottom makes this router quite stable i.e. not prone to toppling off so easily. The front panel of the device has a nice glossy plastic finish with the indicator LEDs



sitting at approximately in the centre of the bottom half of the product. The placement of the power, WPS, Wi-Fi radio switches and the USB port are in an easily accessible location. The device does not come with wall mount.

We managed to squeeze out approximately 250 Mbps on the 2.4GHz band and 360 Mbps on the 5GHz band. However, the 2.4GHz stream wasn't as stable as the 5GHz stream which hardly ever showed any major undulations during the throughput test. When pinged wirelessly the device did have a very fluctuating response. So we wouldn't recommend gaming on Wi-Fi.

At the heart of the device lies the MT7620A which is also present in the C2 but the C2 has GbE ports aside from the external antennae. So if the price difference isn't considerable then we'd pick the C2 over the C20i.

Mitbun Mobandas



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Specifications

Wireless LAN Chip: MediaTek MT7620A+MT7610E; **Memory:** 64 MB; **Protocols:** 802.11 b/g/n/ac; **Bandwidth:** 750(433@5GHz+300@2.4GHz) Mbps; **Ethernet:** 4x LAN, 1x WAN, 10/100 Ports Without modem; **Warranty:** 3 years.

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